

The Wind and the Sun

The Wind and the Sun often argued about which of them was stronger. The Wind boasted that he could bend trees, raise waves, and scatter leaves across whole valleys. The Sun replied that strength was not always loud. One morning, they saw a traveler walking along the road wearing a thick cloak. The Wind proposed a contest: whoever could make the traveler remove his cloak would be declared stronger.

The Sun agreed to let the Wind try first. The Wind gathered himself and blew a sharp gust across the road. The traveler grabbed his cloak at the collar. The Wind blew harder, whistling between the trees and filling the road with dust. The traveler pulled the cloak tighter around his shoulders. Annoyed, the Wind became a storm. He shook branches and drove cold air beneath the cloak, but every blast made the traveler hold on more firmly.

At last the Wind grew tired and fell quiet. The Sun rose higher in the sky. He sent down warm light, first gently, then steadily. The traveler relaxed. The cold had passed, and the road felt pleasant. After a while, the traveler loosened the cloak. When the warmth continued, he took it off entirely and folded it over his arm.

The Wind frowned. "You did not force him," he said. The Sun answered, "No. I gave him a reason to choose." The Wind looked down the road and considered how his power had met resistance at every step. His blasts had been strong, but they had made the traveler defensive.

From then on, the two still had different natures. The Wind continued to sweep across mountains, and the Sun continued to warm fields. But the Wind remembered the traveler whenever he wanted to win an argument by force. He learned that gentleness can achieve what pressure cannot, because people often open when they feel safe and close themselves when they feel attacked. The Sun's quiet warmth had shown a kind of strength the Wind had not understood.